

A COZY HALLOWEEN MURDER MYSTERY PARTY GAME

The Candlewick *Costume Ball* MURDER

A Cozy Halloween Murder Mystery Party Game

6–14 PLAYERS · AGES 12+ · PRINTABLE PDF

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CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

READ ME FIRST

Start *Here*



Thank you for choosing The Candlewick Costume Ball Murder, a cozy Halloween murder mystery for 6–14 players, ages 12+. The host plays Detective Ira Gilchrist and solves the case alongside everyone else.

File	Who reads it	What it is
00 START HERE	The host	This file: what each file is, what to print, FAQ.
01 Host Guide	The host	Party This Weekend? plan, casting, timetables, Scripts 1–4. No spoilers.
02 Invitations	Guests	14 character invitations, 1 open invitation, a text version.
03 Cast List	Everyone	Public: who is who and what they wear.
10–23 Booklets	One player each	10–15 are in every game; 16–23 are optional.
24 All Booklets	The host	All 14 booklets in one file (56 pages).
30 Evidence Cards	A helper	E1–E12 plus optional card backs.
31–33	Players	Name tags, accusation ballots, Detective Notes.
34–35	Optional	Awards, table signs, legend poster, decor.
99 SOLUTION	A player, last	The answer and Script 5. Do not open it.

Print in this order

1. 01 Host Guide (or read it on screen). Its casting chart tells you which booklets to use.
2. The booklets for your guest count, **single-sided**. Then 30 (a helper cuts it), 31, 32, 33 and any extras.
3. 99 last, face down, without looking. Or keep it on a phone.

THREE GOLDEN RULES

Don't open file 99 until every ballot is in. **Print booklets single-sided** (or cut page 3 on its dashed line) so later rounds can't show through. **Ask another guest or a family member to cut the evidence cards** and sort them into three envelopes, without the host reading them, so you can play too.

Print List

One set for your party. "Fixed" is the same for every party: 01 Host Guide (16) + 03 Cast List (3) + 30 Evidence Cards pages 1–2 (2) + 31 Name Tags (2) + 99 Solution (6) = 29 pages.

Players	Booklets	Booklet pp.	32 Ballots	33 Notes	Fixed	Full set	Minimum
6	10–15	24	2	6	29	**61**	**28**
7	10–16	28	2	7	29	**66**	**32**
8	10–17	32	2	8	29	**71**	**36**
9	10–18	36	3	9	29	**77**	**41**
10	10–19	40	3	10	29	**82**	**45**
11	10–20	44	3	11	29	**87**	**49**
12	10–21	48	3	12	29	**92**	**53**
13	10–22	52	4	13	29	**98**	**58**
14	10–23	56	4	14	29	**103**	**62**

Full set = booklet pages (4 per player) + ballot sheets (1 per 4 players) + Detective Notes (1 per player) + fixed pages. **Minimum** = booklet pages + 30 Evidence Cards pages 1–2 (2) + ballot sheets, with 01 and 99 read on a screen. That is the "Party This Weekend?" plan in the Host Guide: **28 pages for 6 players.**

OPTIONAL EXTRAS (NOT COUNTED ABOVE)

02 Invitations (9 pages, or send the text version or the E-Invites instead) · 30 page 3, card backs (1) · 34 Awards & Table Signs (6) · 35 Legend & Decor (4).

PREFER ONE FILE?

24 All Booklets Combined holds all 14 booklets (56 pages). Booklet 10 is pages 1–4, booklet 11 pages 5–8, and so on to booklet 23 on pages 53–56. Print only the page ranges you need.

15–20 GUESTS

Print the 14-player set plus a blank name tag per extra guest. Pairs share optional booklets (see the casting chart in the Host Guide).

Questions & Answers

Can the host play too?

Yes. The host plays Detective Ira Gilchrist, who is not a suspect but guesses along with everyone. The Host Guide never reveals the answer. Ask a helper to cut the evidence cards, and a player to read the solution after the vote.

Is it OK for teens, families and coworkers?

Yes. It's for ages 12+: spooky-cozy, never scary. No gore, no adult jokes, no flirting and no drinking tasks. Vesper simply falls asleep in a chair and never wakes.

Do we need to drink?

No. The cider in the story is alcohol-free, and every drink idea in the Host Guide is too.

Can we play at a costume party that isn't Halloween?

Yes. A birthday, an autumn party or any masked costume party works; just say "a costume ball" instead of Halloween.

My party is this weekend. Is that enough time?

Yes. See "Party This Weekend?" in the Host Guide: a one-hour prep plan and 28 printed pages for 6 players.

Black-and-white printing?

Yes. Text is near-black on light paper, and rounds are marked with 1, 2 or 3 pumpkins plus the words ROUND 1, 2, 3.

ABOUT THIS GAME

The Candlewick Costume Ball Murder is an original story by Clue & Candle Games, written with AI assistance, then edited by hand and checked clue by clue for fair play and a consistent timeline. All names and places are fictional.

HELP

Questions or a printing problem? Email chenphien@gmail.com. Refunds within 14 days of purchase.